

RIVERSIDE CRICKET CLUB — COACHING MANUAL

Section 1 — Batting Fundamentals

A solid stance is the foundation of good batting. Feet shoulder-width apart, knees slightly flexed, eyes level. The grip should be firm but relaxed, hands together. Watch the ball from the bowler's hand all the way onto the bat. The most common fault among new players is taking the eyes off the ball at the moment of contact.

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Section 2 — Bowling Technique

A repeatable action matters more than raw pace for young bowlers. Focus on a smooth run-up, a high front arm, and following through toward the target. Line and length beat speed at club level. A good length ball forces the batter to commit neither fully forward nor fully back.

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Section 3 — Fielding and Catching

Field placement is the captain's responsibility. Close catchers must watch the edge of the bat. When catching, give with the hands to absorb the pace. Backing up throws prevents overthrows. A sharp fielding side can save thirty runs in an innings, which often decides tight matches.

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Section 4 — Wicketkeeping

The keeper stands up to the stumps for spin and back for pace. Watch the ball into the gloves, stay low, and rise with the bounce. Good keepers are quiet and consistent rather than spectacular. The keeper is also the on-field general, with the best view of the game's tempo.

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Section 5 — Match Strategy

Setting a target depends on the pitch and the opposition. On a flat pitch, bat first and post a big score. On a damp or turning pitch, bowling first can be the stronger choice. Rotate the strike to keep the scoreboard moving; dot-ball pressure builds wickets at the other end.

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Section 6 — Fitness and Injury Prevention

Warm up thoroughly before play: dynamic stretches, light jogging, and throwing drills. The most common cricket injuries are to the lower back for fast bowlers and to the hamstrings when sprinting between wickets. Bowlers should observe sensible weekly over limits to protect young backs.

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